

BECOMING DIAMOND

PLATFORM RESEARCH REPORT

Independent evaluation of 8 platforms to replace
becomingdiamond.com

RECOMMENDATION

Kajabi

\$143/month · All-in-one · Course quality 8/10

PREPARED APRIL 3, 2026 · 8 PLATFORMS · 4 ANALYSIS DIMENSIONS

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

After evaluating 8 platforms against the specific needs of Becoming Diamond — **course development (highest priority), low onboarding friction, fast migration, and flexible budget** — **Kajabi is the best fit.**

Kajabi scores highest where it matters most: its course builder is genuinely polished (8/10), the student experience is best-in-class with native mobile apps, video hosting is built-in on Wistia infrastructure, drip scheduling handles the 30-day program natively, and the learning curve is moderate (4/10). No external tools are needed.

The runner-up, **Kartra** (\$99/month), offers comparable completeness at a lower price with stronger automation, but its dated UI and ticket-only support make it harder for a busy non-technical user. The budget option, **Systeme.io** (\$19-27/month), is remarkable value but sacrifices course polish — no quizzes, no certificates, basic player.

Go High Level — the platform that prompted this research — is an excellent tool for marketing agencies, but it's the wrong tool here. Its course builder is adequate (6/10), but the learning curve is the steepest viable option (7/10) and the interface is overwhelming for non-technical users.

RECOMMENDATION

BEST FIT

Kajabi — Basic Plan, \$143/month (annual)

FACTOR	ASSESSMENT
Course builder	8/10. Modules, drip, progress tracking, cohorts, certificates, quizzes. Native Wistia video.
Student experience	Best-in-class. Native iOS/Android app. Clean member portal.
Ease of use	4/10 difficulty. Non-technical friendly. 1-2 weeks to comfortable.
All-in-one	Unlimited emails, funnels, checkout, affiliates, community. Zero external tools.
Book sales	Built-in checkout with upsells, order bumps, payment plans.
Migration speed	7-14 days for full 30-day course + landing + emails + checkout.
Support	24/7 live chat on all plans. Weekly workshops. Kajabi University.
Credibility	Brendon Burchard, Amy Porterfield, Justin Welsh (\$10M+) all use it.

Caveats: No A/B testing. 2,500 contact cap on Basic (upgrade when outgrown). Landing page builder is 6/10. \$143/mo before revenue.

RUNNER-UP

Kartra — Starter Plan, \$99/month (annual)

All-in-one at \$44/month less than Kajabi. Best behavioral automation in the comparison. Built-in video hosting with CTA overlays and watch analytics. **Dealbreaker:** Ticket-only support (no live chat). When you're stuck at 10pm, you wait a day for help.

BUDGET OPTION

Systeme.io — Startup Plan, \$19-27/month

Everything you need at 1/7th the price. 0% transaction fees. 3/10 learning curve. **Missing:** quizzes, certificates, advanced engagement. Valid "prove the concept first" strategy — run Systeme.io for 7 months for what 1 month of Kajabi costs.

Avoid

PLATFORM	REASON
WordPress	Trades one engineer dependency for another. 9/10 learning curve. 3-5 hrs/mo maintenance.
ClickFunnels	\$248-297/mo for a 6/10 course builder. Overpriced. Weak email deliverability.
Skool	Can't sell \$14.99 book, no landing pages, no email. Needs 3-4 external tools.
Teachable	Great courses (8/10) but no CRM, no email, no landing pages. Needs 2-3 external tools.

GO HIGH LEVEL: HONEST ASSESSMENT

GHM is built for marketing agencies. You're a coach.

DIMENSION	REALITY
Course builder	6/10. Functional but not polished. No mobile app for students.
Learning curve	7/10 (hardest viable option). "Power tool" UI with features spread across many sections.
What you'd use	Courses, landing page, email, checkout. About 30% of the platform.
What you'd pay for	Multi-account management, pipeline CRM, SMS, reputation management, social scheduler, agency white-labeling.
Hidden costs	SMS + email usage = \$10-30/month on top of \$79-97/mo base.

Verdict: GHM solves the wrong problem. You'd spend 2-4 weeks learning a complex tool, use a fraction of its features, and get a course experience less polished than Kajabi's.

WEIGHTED DECISION MATRIX

CRITERION	WEIGHT	KAJABI	SYSTEME	KARTRA	TEACHABLE	GHL	CF	SKOOL	WP
Course quality	35%	8	6	7	8	6	6	6	9
Ease of use	25%	6	7	4	7	3	4	8	1
All-in-one	20%	9	8	9	4	9	7	2	8
Migration speed	10%	7	8	6	7	5	5	6	2
Value/price	10%	5	10	7	6	7	3	4	3
Weighted score		7.20	7.10	6.45	6.45	5.50	5.15	4.90	4.55
Rank		#1	#2	#3	#3	#5	#6	#7	#8

PRICING COMPARISON

True monthly cost (recommended tier)

PLATFORM	TIER	BASE (ANNUAL)	EXTRA COSTS	TRUE MONTHLY
Systeme.io	Startup	\$19/mo	Stripe only	\$19-27
GHL	Starter	\$79/mo	SMS/email ~\$10-30	\$89-127
Kartra	Starter	\$99/mo	Stripe only	\$99-119
Teachable	Builder	\$69/mo	+ email ~\$29 + pages	\$98-118
Kajabi	Basic	\$143/mo	None	\$143-179
Skool	Single	\$99/mo	+ email + pages + book	\$147-167
WordPress	Full stack	~\$93/mo	+ developer \$100-300	\$193-393
ClickFunnels	Pro	\$248/mo	+ community ~\$20-50	\$268-347

MIGRATION ROADMAP

Phase 1: Setup (days 1-3)

1. Sign up for Kajabi Basic (14-day trial, or 30-day via exit-intent)
2. Connect existing Stripe account
3. Add becomingdiamond.com as custom domain (don't switch DNS yet)
4. Choose a theme/template

Phase 2: Content migration (days 4-10)

1. Create \$14.99 book product with checkout page
2. Upload all 30 videos to Kajabi (native hosting)
3. Build 30-day course structure with drip schedule
4. Set up landing page from template
5. Create lead capture opt-in form
6. Build welcome email sequence

Phase 3: Testing (days 11-12)

1. Test book purchase flow end-to-end
2. Test course enrollment and drip
3. Test email triggers
4. Test on mobile (Kajabi app + browser)
5. Review all pages on mobile and desktop

Phase 4: Go live (days 13-14)

1. **DNS switchover:** Point becomingdiamond.com to Kajabi
2. Verify SSL auto-provisions
3. Test traffic at real domain
4. Update external links (social, Google Business)

Phase 5: Post-migration

1. Archive Next.js repo on GitHub (don't delete)
2. Cancel Bunny Stream subscription
3. Monitor Kajabi analytics for 2 weeks
4. Set up community (optional, included)

Total estimated time: 2-3 weeks at a few hours per day.

RISK ASSESSMENT

RISK	LIKELIHOOD	IMPACT	MITIGATION
Kajabi price increase	Medium	Medium	Annual billing locks rate. Semrush acquisition adds stability.
Outgrowing 2,500 contacts	Medium	Low	Upgrade to Growth (\$199/mo). Good problem to have.
Course content not portable	Low	Medium	Keep original video files locally.
Landing pages feel limiting	Medium	Low	Subdomain with Carrd/Leadpages for campaigns.
Student experience different	Low	Low	Kajabi portal is more polished than most custom builds.

Use Kajabi. \$143/month. Zero external tools. Live in 2-3 weeks. Your 30-day transformation program will look and feel professional from day one.

Prepared April 3, 2026 · Data is point-in-time and may change · Full interactive report available online